

Academic Integrity & AI Use

Original authorship, honest sourcing, and the mandatory AI Annex

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Academic integrity is the commitment to honest, original and properly attributed work. It prohibits plagiarism (using others' words or ideas without credit), fabrication and falsification of data, and misrepresenting authorship. Where generative AI is used, EUBS requires transparency: a mandatory AI Annex documenting each source, and a prohibition on citing AI-generated content as if it were a scholarly source. The work, and the accountability for it, must be the student's own.

THE NON-NEGOTIABLES

Original authorship: the analysis, argument and conclusions are yours. Proper attribution: every idea or phrase from a source is cited. No fabrication: data is real and verifiable. Verified references: you have personally checked every source you cite exists and says what you claim.

THE AI ANNEX

A PowerPoint with one slide per source, each showing a screenshot of the original, ordered alphabetically. Uploaded to OneDrive with a working, tested link pasted under the reference heading. It evidences that your sources are real — a direct guard against hallucinated citations.

AI as assistant, not author. Generative AI can help you brainstorm, structure or check grammar — but it does not do your thinking, and its output is not a citable source. It confidently produces plausible, wrong references and false attributions. Every AI-suggested citation must be independently verified against the original before it enters your work.

Requirement	How it is verified
Original authorship	Similarity check; oral defence questioning
Real references	AI Annex screenshots; spot-checks
Citation matching	In-text ↔ bibliography, both directions
Authentic data	Raw evidence on file; transcript scrutiny

VERIFY, ALWAYS

Never cite a source — AI-suggested or not — without opening it. A single hallucinated reference undermines the whole bibliography's credibility.

KEEP RAW EVIDENCE

Transcripts, datasets, consent forms, coded workbooks. 'Analysis but no raw data' is an authenticity flag you can avoid entirely.

DISCLOSE AI USE

Be transparent about how you used AI tools. Concealment is the integrity breach; honest, documented, assistive use is not.

Common pitfalls. (1) Citing AI output as a scholarly source. (2) Hallucinated or unverified references. (3) An AI Annex with a broken or untested OneDrive link. (4) Primary 'findings' with no raw data on file. (5) Uniform, implausibly consistent interview transcripts.

REFERENCES

Bryman, A. and Bell, E. (2015) *Business Research Methods*. 4th edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. · International Center for Academic Integrity (2021) *The Fundamental Values of Academic Integrity*. 3rd edn. · Follow the EUBS AI Annex and academic-integrity requirements.